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GNIOT Institute of Management Studies – PGDM (Batch 2020-22)

(TRIMESTER – V) END TERM EXAMINATION, JANUARY - 2022

MARKETING OF FINANCIAL SERVICES

[Time: 2 Hours 30 Minutes]

[Maximum Marks: 100]

INSTRUCTIONS:

- (i) There are **THREE** sections in this question paper.
- (ii) Attempt questions from each section as per the directions.
- (iii) Make suitable assumptions wherever necessary.

SECTION-A

(Short Answer Type Questions, do not exceed 100 words)

Q.1. Attempt all parts of the following:**(10×3=30)**

- (a) Define the term 'Financial services'.
- (b) Describe the forces that influence the dynamics of a financial services sector of a country.
- (c) Write short note on 'Portfolio Management'.
- (d) Discuss the role of branding of financial services.
- (e) Explain the steps involved in creating marketing operations strategy.
- (f) Enlist any 5 Financial services.
- (g) Discuss the various factors affecting pricing decision in case of financial services.
- (h) Elaborate the concept of phone banking.
- (i) Differentiate between asset management and wealth management.

SECTION-B

(Long Answer Type Questions)

Attempt all questions of the following:**(4×10=40)**

Q.2. (a) Mutual funds have been a favourite investment option for lot many investors. Discuss the reasons behind this trend.

OR

(b) Elaborate the role of digital tools in marketing of financial services and explain its importance.

Q.3. (a) Discuss the key focus area of marketing operations in reference with the financial services.

OR

(b) Suggest possible steps which a payment bank can take to enhance customer experience.

Q.4. (a) Fintech companies have taken the financial services growth to a new level. In your opinion, what are the key reasons behind grand success of Fintech companies in the recent past?

OR

(b) Develop a multichannel strategy for alternative lending company which is targeting the age group of 20-50 years.

Q.5. (a) Draft a promotion plan for a private sector bank which wants to venture into rural banking.

OR

(b) Elaborate why physical evidence plays a vital role in marketing of financial services.

SECTION-C

Q.6. Attempt all parts of the following:

(2×15=30)

Founded in 2018 by Shams Tabrej, Rashid Ali, and Dilkash Ara, **Ezeepay** is a fintech startup that aims to solve the underpenetration of financial services in rural India. It currently operates in UP, Bihar, Madhya Pradesh, and Jharkhand, and is exploring an expansion to South Indian markets. In a queue one day, to exchange his old, demonetised notes back in 2016, Shams Tabrej noticed how most people around him were daily wage earners and day labourers. He struck up a conversation with a couple of folks and discerned that they had all been standing there since early morning, at the cost of earning a living that day. Shams, who hail from a rural village in Bihar, knew that for most people in his village, accessing financial services for the smallest of things took an entire day, or at least a majority of one's working hours. Trudging all the way to the next village, often 20-30 kilometres away where the nearest bank is located is not unheard of in rural India - and that was the case with Shams as well.

Ezeepay is a financial-technology startup that primarily serves the rural segment. The New Delhi-based venture provides digital banking services such as microloans, insurance, investment buying, AEPS (Aadhaar Enabled Payment System), money transfer, and bank account opening; utility services such as bill payments, mobile recharge, hotel and travel booking; and compliance services such as ITR filing, GST registration, MSME registration, among others. The startup also offers **doorstep digital services** via a large network of on-ground agents. These agents not only help people access digital banking, but also help them conduct online transactions such as bill payments.

It provides all these services at its micro-ATMs and Ezeepay touch point stores across the country, apart from its app. The Ezeepay stores not only enable people to conduct digital banking, but also help users renew their documentation and pay all sorts of bills without having to waste time travelling to different places. The startup mainly earns its money from the banks it has tied up with, on every transaction it helps to conduct on its platform.

Its competitors in India include the likes of **Spice Money** (which enables rural banking by partnering with local kiranas and businesses), **BANKIT**, **JaiKisan**, and Fincare SFB, among others. Bigger startups like **Razorpay** and **Cashfree Payments** are also making a bid to tap underserved users in rural India, where the next billion internet users are widely expected to hail from.

6(a) Throw light on the key challenges that a Fintech company like Ezeepay face in rural area. Suggest what all the company must do to overcome these challenges.

6(b) Suggest an alternate business model through which Ezeepay can expand its business in rural market.